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# THE DARKNET FOR GOOD

## How the deep web fosters anonymity and privacy

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There is little doubt that whistle blowers have had a significant impact on politics, economy and business. People like Edward Snowden and Julian Assange have demonstrated how whistle-blowers can change public opinion and hold governments to account for their shenanigans and wrong doings. But the rockstar



This is probably not what a whistle blower looks like

aura that has been bestowed on some whistle blowers should not blind us to the risks that they have taken to bring sensitive and secret information to light.

That's because whistleblowing involves pointing fingers at someone or some organization that's powerful.

Whistleblowers are a breed apart, and they are often the source for shocking exposes that open the world's eyes to a hitherto unknown facet about a renowned individual, a company or a nation. And the repercussions for whistleblowers could be dire – from

being maligned and sued, to being jailed or physically eliminated. After all, you can scarcely expect the powerful to sit by idly when hitherto secret information is revealed to the world.

Thankfully, technology is helping many modern whistleblowers to publish their stories without revealing their identity. Even sites like Wikileaks wouldn't exist without secret networks that exist beneath the public Internet. And these hidden or underground



But this certainly is

networks, collectively called the Deep Web or Darknet, owe their existence to services like TOR that provide a secure communication environment and ensure user anonymity.

One example of service that helps whistleblowers is Dead Man Zero. This site gives whistleblowers the option to have their information automatically published if they get kidnapped, jailed, injured or worse. The site is accessed using the Tor browser, and all you need to do is to upload your sensitive files into a cloud storage service. The files

can be encrypted with a password, and you can also include a description of your content. The site then adds its own encryption to the files, making them extra-secure. Afterwards, you get a unique URL using which you can log in. While uploading the files, you can specify a time period (once every day, once a week or once every month). If you do not log into the site within that time period, your files will automatically be sent to a list of email addresses that you



Dead man zero: The Whistleblower's insurance policy

have provided in advance—allowing you to disseminate the information.

### The Deep Web

You may be astonished to know that there is a vast amount of information that is not “indexed” and served up in search results by popular search engines like Google, Bing or Yahoo. These sources collectively comprise the Deep Web, and can include all kinds of places—from academic databases to private websites and corporate portals. Very often these sources are hidden